

# Programming Fundamentals 1

An Introduction to the module

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# Agenda

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- *Lecturers / Tutors*
- *Module Structure & Delivery*
- *Technologies*
- *Module Assessment (Assignments)*
- *Troubleshooting*
- *Ethos*

# Introducing your lecturers / tutors

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## Siobhan Roche

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## Mairead Meagher

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Programming Technologies

## Assignments



100% Continuous Assessment (CA).



All Individual assignments (no team-based ones).



Submit via Moodle assignment dropboxes.



Hard deadlines; extensions only permitted if [mitigating circumstances](#) apply.



Interviews

# *What to do if you don't know what to do...*

**Ask in Class or at labs:** Just put your hand up or wait until the end of the class, its up to you but asking during the class really helps all the students



**Message your lecturer in Slack:** You can always send us a private message and we will respond before the end of the next college day.



**Post the issue in Slack;**  
think of it as asking a question in a classroom.  
Include any screen shots, screen recordings, etc.  
you think might help with solving the problem.



We encourage classmates to help each other (**peer learning**), if you know the answer to another student's issue, please do respond.

# Ethos

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- **Self-directed learning** outside of lectures / labs.
- Inquisitive and motivated.
- Help your **peers (use #Slack!)**.
- **Engagement** and staying current with the module.
- All work submitted must be **your own work**.
  - all code/approaches given in the module by us can be re-used / re-purposed in your assignments.

# Introduction to BlueJ





# What is BlueJ?

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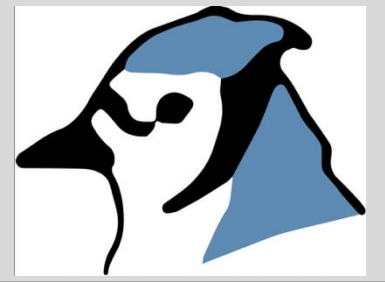
**BlueJ** is a simple program you'll use to learn Java. It's designed for beginners, so it avoids the clutter of professional coding tools and lets you focus on the basics.

- You'll see your program as boxes (classes) that you can click on.
- You can create objects and test what they can do without writing extra code.
- The editor helps you write neatly and spot mistakes more easily.
- It's free and works on most computers.

Think of BlueJ as training wheels for Java: it helps you experiment, see results quickly, and understand the core ideas of programming.



# What language is behind Bluej



BlueJ doesn't come with its own Java — it depends on the Java Development Kit (JDK) you install.

The **current release (BlueJ 5.7.0, May 2024)** works with:

- *Java 11 (LTS)*
- **Java 17 (LTS)**
- **Java 21 (LTS, current recommended version)**

# Why are we using BlueJ?

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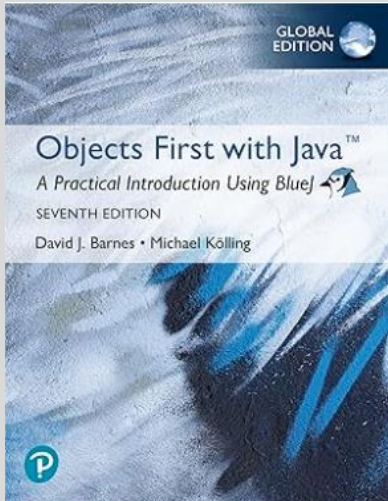
- It's developed for introductory programming courses
- Objects first approach
- Minimal interface and reduced distraction versus full Integrated Development Environments
- Immediate Feedback

# References

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- This course is largely based on the Book



Objects First with Java: A Practical Introduction  
Using BlueJ,  
Global Edition Paperback – 21 July 2025  
by David Barnes (Author), Michael Kölling (Author)

# Questions?

